Name: ..... Due: **Next Class / Friday**

C3 Direct to Tape Mono Recordings HW 3 – Elvis Presley 'Mystery Train' & Sun Studio

Artist: Elvis Presley (Sun Studio, Memphis, TN, Producer & Engineer: Sam Phillips)
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=XA5HErVE9oI

1. In 1955, Sam Phillips recorded Elvis Presley direct-to-tape at Sun Studio. Identify the sonic characteristics and instrumentation in the table below. (3)

Instrument / Element	Performance & Acoustic Role
Lead Vocals (Elvis Presley)	Slapback Tape Echo applied
Lead Electric Guitar (Scotty Moore)	
Upright Slap Bass (Bill Black)	
Drums / Percussion	None / Percussive guitar body slap

2. Describe the vocal effect heard immediately following each vocal phrase (slapback echo). What is the approximate delay time in milliseconds? (1)

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3. What year was this track recorded at Sun Studio, and give ONE reason why Sam Phillips did not use stereo panning? (2)

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4. Explain the tape machine routing Sam Phillips used to create his legendary "slapback echo". Detail the role of the Record head, Playback head, tape speed (15 ips), and tape loop path. (4)

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5. In 1950s live room recordings, early hollow-body electric guitars suffered from severe acoustic feedback and 50/60 Hz hum. Explain how the invention of the humbucker pickup solved these issues. (4)

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6. Describe how you would mic a slap-bass upright acoustic bass in a modern studio to capture both the deep low-end resonance and the high-frequency fingerboard "click": (4)

Two-Microphone Setup / DI Choice (2)
Mic 1 (Low End) / DI: Mic 2 (Fingerboard Click):
Placement, Polar Patterns & Phase Alignment (2)

Total:	**/18**